Practice workbook · Types of error and whether the trial balance shows them

Naming a described error (omission, commission, principle, original entry, complete reversal, compensating), telling two types apart, and knowing which errors do or do not upset the totals.

18 question parts: 1 worked-example retry and 17 further practice parts.
Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

Practise one question type at a time. Attempt the part inside the red boundary; the rest of the question and any figures are kept for context. Write your working in the answer space.

The first question is a retry of the website worked example, without its solution. Check your answers online with 'Check my answer', or ask your teacher for the answer booklet.

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Type ID: ACC-CTL-07

1. Question 16 · part b · 5 marks

2023 JUN · Paper 01 (regional R)

Worked-example retry · Attempt part b only.

16 (a) Prepare the trial balance at 31 March 2023.

(8)

Trial balance at 31 March 2023			
Account	**Balance $**	**Debit $**	**Credit $**
Bank overdraft	195		
Drawings	11 380		
Equity	21 750		
General expenses	20 110		
Inventory at 1 April 2022	23 060		
Motor expenses	2015		
Motor vehicles – cost	95 880		
Motor vehicles – provision for depreciation	23 970		
Provision for irrecoverable debts	1 250		
Purchases	86 250		
Returns outwards	1 090		
Revenue	196 300		
Trade payables ledger control account	18 150		
Trade receivables ledger control account	24 010		
Total			

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1. Question 16 · part b · 5 marks

2023 JUN · Paper 01 (regional R)

Worked-example retry · Attempt part b only.

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(b) State the type of error made in **each** scenario.

(5)

Scenario	Type of error
A purchase invoice was not entered in the day book.	
A cash purchase was debited to the cash account and credited to the purchases account.	
Goods purchased on credit from Tessa had been posted to the account of Nessa.	
The purchase of a motor vehicle had been entered in the motor expenses account.	
The total of a sales invoice was incorrectly entered in the day book.	

The discount received account and discount allowed account had both been overstated by the same amount.

(c) Identify, indicating with a tick (✓), which account will be debited and which account will be credited in order to correct this error.

(2)

Account	Account to be debited	Account to be credited
Discount received		
Discount allowed		

(Total for Question 16 = 15 marks)

1. Question 16 · part b · 5 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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2. Question 15 · part c.ii · 1 mark

2023 JAN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part c.ii only.

15 (a) Complete the corrected trial balance.

(10)

Trial Balance at 30 September 2022

	Draft trial balance		Corrected trial balance	
Account	**Debit $**	**Credit $**	**Debit $**	**Credit $**
Bank overdraft		4 250		
Carriage inwards		480		
Discount allowed	370			
Drawings		8 300		
Equity		17 800		
General expenses	14 350			
Inventory 1 October 2021		7 200		
Irrecoverable debts		390		
Loan to employee	100			
Motor vehicle – cost	22 300			
Motor vehicle – provision for depreciation		13 380		
Premises	44 000			
Purchases	64 380			
Rent received	480			
Returns inwards		550		
Revenue		124 800		
Trade payables		8 420		
Trade receivables	6 710			
Total				

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2. Question 15 · part c.ii · 1 mark

2023 JAN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part c.ii only.

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(b) Explain what is indicated if both totals of a trial balance are the same.

(2)

(c) (i) State **one** difference between an error of **commission** and an error of **principle**.

(2)

(ii) State **one** other type of error that does **not** affect the balancing of the trial balance.

(1)

(Total for Question 15 = 15 marks)

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Working and answer

3. Question 15 · part a · 2 marks

2025 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part a only.

15 (a) State **two** types of error that do **not** affect the balancing of the trial balance.

(2)

1 .....

2 .....

Brandon, a sole trader, has prepared a trial balance that does not balance.

He discovers the following errors in his books of account at 30 April 2025.

1. The motor expenses account had been undercast by $200
2. The purchase of a motor vehicle, $2 000, had been entered in the motor expenses account.
3. A receipt from Palmer, a trade receivable, $60, had been posted to the account of Parker.
4. A cheque payment for wages, $154, had been correctly recorded in the bank account but had been posted to the wages account as $145
5. A cheque payment for stationery, $40, had been debited to the bank account and credited to the stationery account.

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3. Question 15 · part a · 2 marks

2025 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part a only.

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(b) Prepare journal entries to correct **each** error. Narratives are **not** required.

(10)

Journal

Date 2025	Account	Debit $	Credit $
April 30			

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(c) Prepare the suspense account at 30 April 2025.

(3)

Suspense Account

Date 2025	Details	$	Date 2025	Details	$

(Total for Question 15 = 15 marks)

3. Question 15 · part a · 2 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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4. Question 9 · part whole · 1 mark

2020 NOV · Paper 01 (regional R)

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

9 Which error would be disclosed by the preparation of a trial balance?

- ☒ **A** Purchase of goods on credit, $290, omitted from the books
- ☒ **B** Receipt of a cheque from Jones, $56, entered in the account of James as $65
- ☒ **C** Sale of goods on credit for $350 entered on both sides of the ledger as $250
- ☒ **D** Wages account and revenue account both overcast by $100

(Total for Question 9 = 1 mark)

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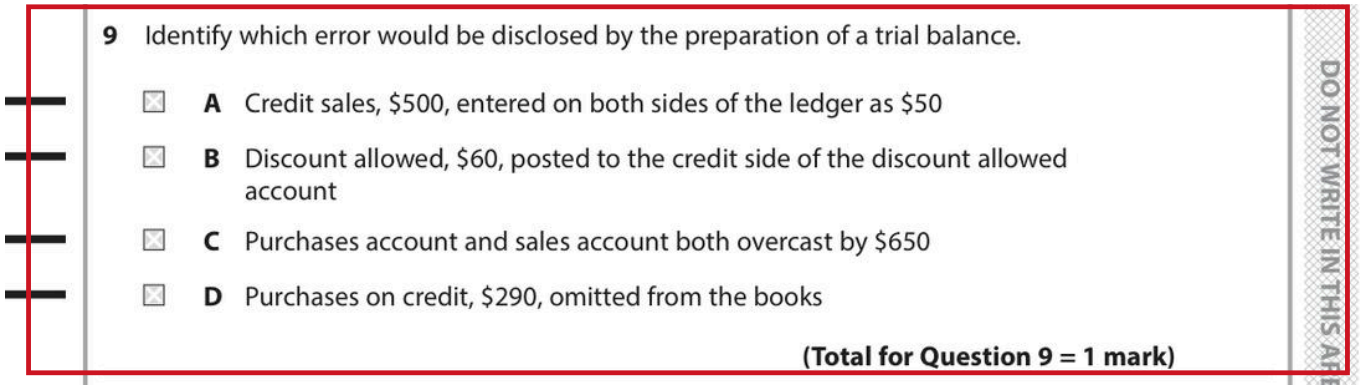
Working and answer

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5. Question 9 · part whole · 1 mark

2023 JAN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.



9 Identify which error would be disclosed by the preparation of a trial balance.

- ☒ **A** Credit sales, $500, entered on both sides of the ledger as $50
- ☒ **B** Discount allowed, $60, posted to the credit side of the discount allowed account
- ☒ **C** Purchases account and sales account both overcast by $650
- ☒ **D** Purchases on credit, $290, omitted from the books

(Total for Question 9 = 1 mark)

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Working and answer

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6. Question 7 · part whole · 1 mark

2020 JAN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

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7 Which **one** of the following errors would require a correcting entry in a suspense account?

- ☐ **A** Credit note entered twice in the books of account
- ☐ **B** Incorrect addition of the total column of the sales day book
- ☐ **C** Payment for stationery posted to office equipment
- ☐ **D** Sales invoice not entered in the books of account

(Total for Question 7 = 1 mark)

Working and answer

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7. Question 15 · part a · 3 marks

2019 JUN · Paper 01 (regional R)

Further practice · Attempt part a only.

15 Yasin has prepared a trial balance at 30 April 2019 that did not balance. The totals were debit $41 970 and credit $42 550.

The following errors and omissions were discovered.

1. The total of the sales day book had been overcast by $200.
2. Motor repairs, $180, had been posted to the debit side of the motor vehicles account.
3. A payment of $450 to Raul, a credit supplier, had been entered correctly in the cash book but had not been posted to Raul's account.
4. Discounts received of $80 had been posted to the debit side of the discounts allowed account.
5. Cash sales, $540, had not been recorded.
6. A payment for rent $430 had been recorded correctly in the cash book but as $340 in the rent account.

(a) Complete the table.

(3)

Error	Type of error
2	
5	
6	

(b) Prepare the suspense account at 30 April 2019.

(6)

Suspense Account

Date	Details	$	Date	Details	$

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7. Question 15 · part a · 3 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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8. Question 5 · part whole · 1 mark

2019 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

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5 Ben records motor vehicle expenses in the motor vehicle account in error.

What type of error is this?

- ☒ **A** Commission
- ☒ **B** Complete reversal
- ☒ **C** Original entry
- ☒ **D** Principle

(Total for Question 5 = 1 mark)

Working and answer

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9. Question 15 · part b · 3 marks

2020 JAN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

15 (a) Complete the following sentence.

The main purpose of a trial balance is to check

the .... of the

double entry.

(2)

(b) Identify the type of error in **each** case.

(3)

Error	Type of error
A payment for motor expenses had been posted to the motor vehicle account.	
A payment for general expenses had not been recorded.	
A payment for general expenses had been posted to the motor expenses account.	

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9. Question 15 · part b · 3 marks

2020 JAN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

(c) Complete the trial balance at 31 December 2019. Any difference should be entered in the suspense account.

(10)

Trial Balance at 31 December 2019

Account	Balance $	Trial balance	
		Debit $	Credit $
Bank overdraft	770		
Carriage inwards	880		
Discount allowed	340		
Drawings	4 500		
Equity	9 090		
General expenses	15 110		
Inventory	12 260		
Irrecoverable debts	700		
Motor expenses	2 400		
Motor vehicle – cost	9 800		
Motor vehicle – provision for depreciation	2 440		
Purchases	48 000		
Returns outwards	940		
Revenue	86 910		
Trade payables	3 620		
Trade receivables	10 050		
Suspense			
Total			

(Total for Question 15 = 15 marks)

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9. Question 15 · part b · 3 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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10. Question 17 · part b · 2 marks

2020 NOV · Paper 01 (regional R)

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

17 (a) Prepare the trial balance from the list of balances.

(8)

Trial balance at 31 March 2020

Account	Balance $	Trial balance	
		Debit $	Credit $
Bank loan	2 000		
Bank overdraft	160		
Carriage outwards	650		
Discount received	190		
Drawings	5 130		
Equity	19 500		
Fixtures and fittings – cost – provision for depreciation	 24 400 6 350		
General expenses	16 870		
Inventory at 1 April 2019	18 750		
Provision for irrecoverable debts	300		
Purchases	42 630		
Returns inwards	2 580		
Revenue	88 320		
Trade payables ledger control account	5 230		
Trade receivables ledger control account	11 040		
Total			

(b) State **each** type of error.

(2)

Error	Type of error
Purchase of a motor vehicle had been entered in the motor expenses account.	
Wages paid had been posted to the general expenses account.	

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10. Question 17 · part b · 2 marks

2020 NOV · Paper 01 (regional R)

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

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(c) State **one** benefit of computerised bookkeeping.

(1)

.....

(d) State **two** methods of protecting data from unauthorised access.

(2)

1 .....

2 .....

(e) State **one** difference between a public sector organisation and a private sector organisation.

(2)

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(Total for Question 17 = 15 marks)

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Working and answer

11. Question 16 · part a · 1 mark

2021 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part a only.

16 At the end of his financial year, 31 March 2021, Jacques prepared a trial balance and opened a suspense account with a debit balance of $210

Jacques has found the following errors.

1. Motor insurance, $400, had been posted to the debit side of the motor vehicles account.
2. A cheque received from a credit customer, $650, had been entered correctly in the cash book but had been entered as $560 on the credit side of the customer's account.
3. A direct debit, $120, for general expenses had not been entered.
4. Returns inwards, $150, had been posted to the credit side of the returns outwards account.

(a) State the type of error made in error 1.

(1)

.....

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11. Question 16 · part a · 1 mark

2021 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part a only.

(b) Prepare journal entries to correct **each** of the errors.

Narratives are **not** required.

(9)

Date 2021	Error	Details	Debit $	Credit $
31 March	1			
	2			
	3			
	4			

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11. Question 16 · part a · 1 mark · Working and answer

Working and answer

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12. Question 14 · part c · 3 marks

2021 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part c only.

14 (a) State **one** advantage and **one** disadvantage of preparing a trial balance.

(2)

Advantage

.....

.....

Disadvantage

.....

.....

(b) Complete the table, using a tick (✓), to identify in which column of the trial balance each item would be entered. The first item has been completed as an example.

(10)

	Debit	Credit
Inventory	✓	
Bank overdraft		
Carriage inwards		
Discount received		
Drawings		
Equity		
Machinery – provision for depreciation		
Provision for irrecoverable debts		
Rent received		
Returns inwards		
Trade receivables		

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12. Question 14 · part c · 3 marks

2021 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part c only.

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(c) Identify the type of error in **each** scenario.

(3)

Scenario	Type of error
A payment for general expenses had been posted to the drawings account.	
A payment for stationery had been posted to the rent paid account.	
An invoice for $320 had been recorded in the purchases day book as $230.	

(Total for Question 14 = 15 marks)

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Working and answer

13. Question 4 · part whole · 1 mark

2022 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

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4 Identify the type of error when a sales invoice for $500 is entered in the sales day book as $450.

- ☒ **A** Commission
- ☒ **B** Compensating
- ☒ **C** Original entry
- ☒ **D** Principle

(Total for Question 4 = 1 mark)

Working and answer

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14. Question 14 · part b · 2 marks

2023 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

14 Rodrigo provided the following balances at 30 April 2023.

(a) Prepare the trial balance entering any difference in an appropriate account.

(9)

Trial balance at 30 April 2023			
Account	**Balance $**	**Debit $**	**Credit $**
Bank loan	18 450		
Carriage inwards	183		
Cash	3 964		
Drawings	19 730		
Equipment cost	37 860		
Equipment provision for depreciation	13 940		
Equity	28 500		
General expenses	21 010		
Inventory at 1 May 2022	23 940		
Purchases	69 875		
Revenue	136 210		
Trade payables ledger control	8 352		
Trade receivables ledger control	17 197		
Wages	6 000		
Total			

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14. Question 14 · part b · 2 marks

2023 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

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(b) State the type of error in each scenario.

(2)

Scenario	Type of error
Cash drawings of $175 had not been recorded.	
Wages of $180 had been recorded in the cash book as $80	

(c) Explain the effect on owner's equity of:

(i) **not** recording cash drawings of $175

(2)

(ii) recording wages as $80 instead of $180

(2)

(Total for Question 14 = 15 marks)

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Working and answer

15. Question 14 · part b.i · 2 marks

2022 JUN · Paper 01 (regional R)

Further practice · Attempt part b.i only.

14 (a) State **two** purposes of preparing a trial balance. (2)

1 .....

2 .....

(b) State **one** difference between:

(i) an error of commission and an error of principle (2)

.....

.....

.....

.....

(ii) an error of original entry and an error of omission. (2)

.....

.....

.....

.....

(c) Identify, indicating with a tick (✓), where each account balance would be shown in a trial balance. (4)

Account	Trial balance	
	Debit $	Credit $
Carriage inwards		
Carriage outwards		
Returns inwards		
Returns outwards		

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15. Question 14 · part b.i · 2 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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16. Question 14 · part b.ii · 2 marks

2022 JUN · Paper 01 (regional R)

Further practice · Attempt part b.ii only.

14 (a) State **two** purposes of preparing a trial balance. (2)

1 .....

2 .....

(b) State **one** difference between:

(i) an error of commission and an error of principle (2)

.....

.....

.....

.....

(ii) an error of original entry and an error of omission. (2)

.....

.....

.....

.....

(c) Identify, indicating with a tick (✓), where each account balance would be shown in a trial balance. (4)

Account	Trial balance	
	Debit $	Credit $
Carriage inwards		
Carriage outwards		
Returns inwards		
Returns outwards		

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16. Question 14 · part b.ii · 2 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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17. Question 15 · part c.i · 2 marks

2023 JAN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part c.i only.

15 (a) Complete the corrected trial balance.

(10)

Trial Balance at 30 September 2022

	Draft trial balance		Corrected trial balance	
Account	**Debit $**	**Credit $**	**Debit $**	**Credit $**
Bank overdraft		4 250		
Carriage inwards		480		
Discount allowed	370			
Drawings		8 300		
Equity		17 800		
General expenses	14 350			
Inventory 1 October 2021		7 200		
Irrecoverable debts		390		
Loan to employee	100			
Motor vehicle – cost	22 300			
Motor vehicle – provision for depreciation		13 380		
Premises	44 000			
Purchases	64 380			
Rent received	480			
Returns inwards		550		
Revenue		124 800		
Trade payables		8 420		
Trade receivables	6 710			
Total				

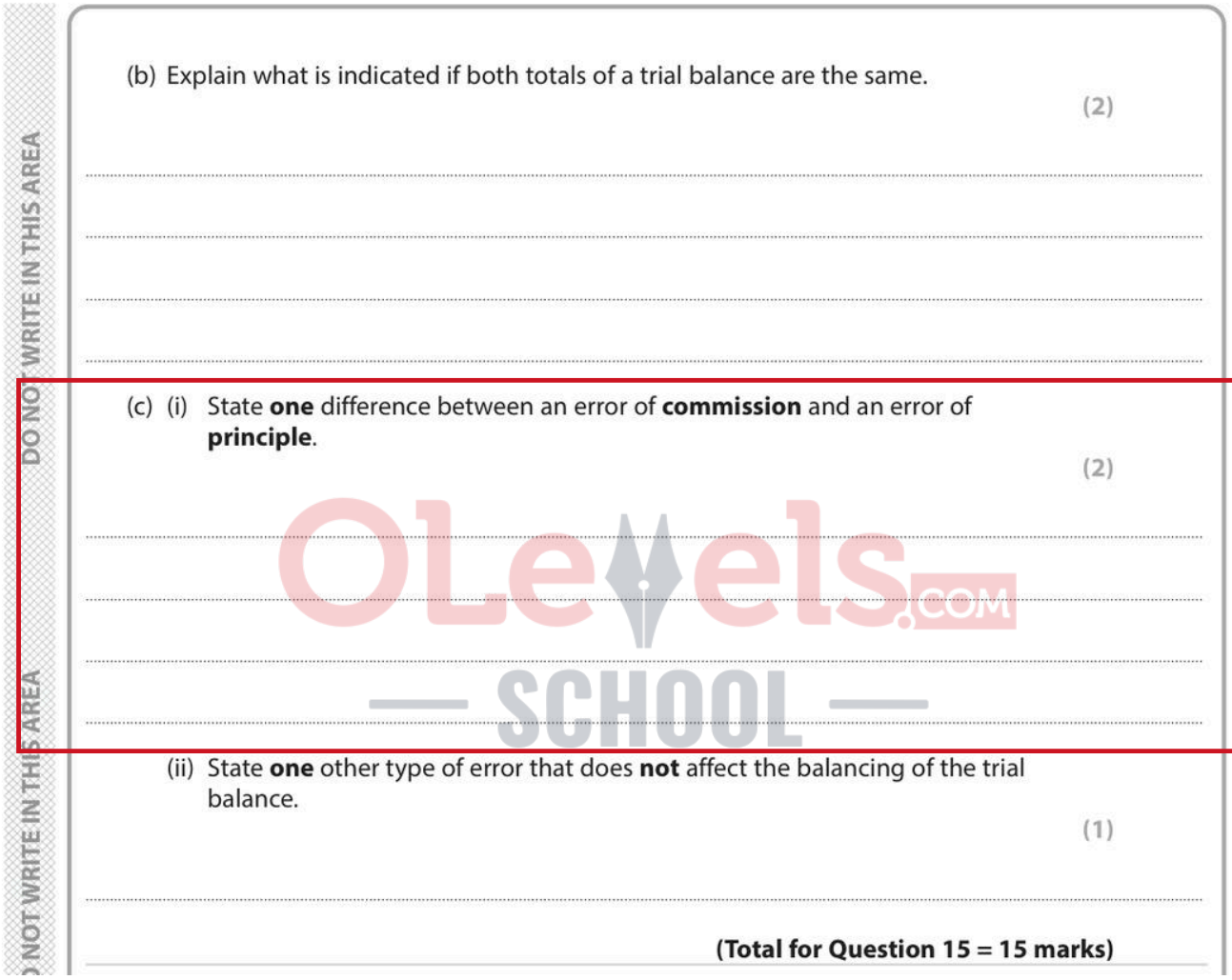
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17. Question 15 · part c.i · 2 marks

2023 JAN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part c.i only.



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(b) Explain what is indicated if both totals of a trial balance are the same.

(2)

(c) (i) State **one** difference between an error of **commission** and an error of **principle**.

(2)

(ii) State **one** other type of error that does **not** affect the balancing of the trial balance.

(1)

(Total for Question 15 = 15 marks)

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Working and answer

18. Question 15 · part i · 5 marks

2024 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part i only.

15 On 31 May 2024, Hassan identified the following errors.

Error	
1	An invoice from a supplier, $215, had been entered in the purchases day book as $251
2	Motor expenses, $76, had been posted to the motor vehicles account.
3	No entries had been made for goods, cost $850, taken by Hassan for his own use.
4	Sales, $890, to Mali had been posted to the account of Marley.
5	Additional equity introduced by Hassan, $3 500, had been debited to the equity account and credited to the bank account.

(i) State the type of error in **each** scenario.

(5)

Error	Type of error
1	
2	
3	
4	
5	

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18. Question 15 · part i · 5 marks

2024 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part i only.

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(ii) Prepare journal entries to correct **all** errors. Narratives are **not** required.

(10)

Journal

Date	Account	Debit $	Credit $
May 31			

(Total for Question 15 = 15 marks)

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18. Question 15 · part i · 5 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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